

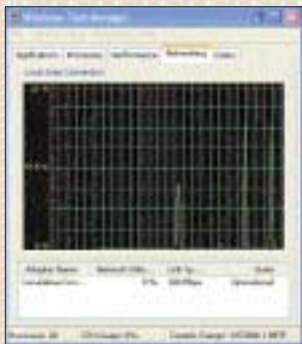


Disabling the ICF

LAN, as File and Printer Sharing services are blocked. It would make sense to disable the ICF if you intend to use File and Printer Sharing services that would be essential in a LAN environment. To disable the ICF, go to the Control Panel, and select the Network Connections. Open this and right-click on the desired connection, click on Properties and under the Advanced tab, disable ICF.

Viewing the network utilisation

You can view the current percentage of network utilisation in the Windows XP task manager. Open the Task Manager by holding down [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Esc] and click on the



View the network utilisation

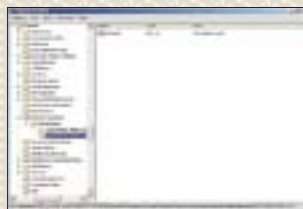
Networking tab. You will then see the real-time graph of network utilisation.

IPConfig in XP

Windows XP doesn't feature the GUI Win IP Config tool, so to quickly locate all the relevant TCP/IP configuration details, you will need to use the command line IP Config tool, accessed by typing **ipconfig**.

Faster Windows sharing

When you try to view the shared folders on a computer running Windows 98 or ME from a PC running Windows 2000, there may be a delay of up to 30 seconds. This is



Open up shared folders within Windows 98/ME faster

because Windows 2000 tries to determine if any 'Scheduled Tasks' are enabled on the other computer. You can fix this delay by deleting a Registry entry on the Windows 2000 machine—but only after backing up the Registry before making any edits.

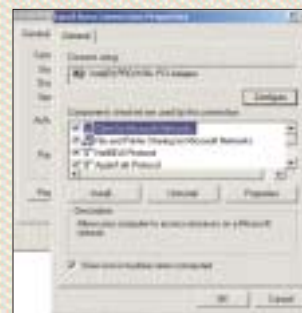
Go to **Start > Run** and type **REGEDIT** to open the Registry Editor. Navigate to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\RemoteComputer\NameSpace**, and locate the subkey that reads {D6277990-4C6A-11CF-

8D87-00AA0060F5BF}.

First click on Export and save the selected branch as, say, **restoreshare.reg** in a folder. Once you have exported a copy of the key, right-click on this subkey and click on Delete. This should fix the problem.

Network indicator

On a PC with a modem, you can see the little flashing computers in the System Tray



Turning on the network monitor

that shows you that there is some data flowing. Now in Windows 2000, you can see the same flashing computers style indicator for your local network.

Right-click on My Network Places, click on the Local Area Connection. Click on the Properties button. At the bottom of the Properties window, you will see the Show Icon in taskbar when connected option. Enable this and you will see the indicator.

Routing your way

Windows 2000 has a very powerful command line tool, the Route command that can be used to view, and even change the computer's rout-



Routing data in Windows 2000

ing table. This can affect the path that the network traffic takes to get from one place to the other. Be careful while editing the routing table though—a little mistake here could play havoc with your network communications. You can find out the different options for usage by typing **route/?** at the command line.

Pathping

The pathping command line utility in Windows 2000 gives you the best of ping and tracer, by sending out packets to each router on the way to a final destination over a period



Use pathping to determine any weak links on the network

of time, and then computes the results based on the packets returned from each hop. Since pathping shows the degree of packet loss at any given router or link, you can use it to determine which routers or links might be causing network problems.

Type **pathping /?** at the command prompt to get additional information on